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GDS (CONDUCT AND ENGAGEMENT) RULES, 2020

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GRAMIN DAK SEVAKS (CONDUCT AND ENGAGEMENT) RULES, 2020

In supersession of the Department of Posts, Gramin Dak Sevaks (Conduct and Engagement) Rules, 2011, except as respects things done or omitted to be done before such supersession, the following rules are issued under the authority of the Government of India.

Rule 3: Definitions**Gramin Dak Sevak (GDS)**

A Gramin Dak Sevak refers to the following categories of posts:

S.No.	GDS Post	Description of Post
1	Branch Postmaster (BPM)	GDS working as Postmaster in a Branch Office.
2	Assistant Branch Postmaster (ABPM)	GDS other than BPM working in a Branch Office.
3	Dak Sevak	GDS other than BPM/ABPM working in a Head Office, Sub Office, or RMS office.

Members of Family

In relation to a Sevak, "Members of Family" includes:

- The wife, child, or step-child of such Sevak, whether residing with him or not.
- In relation to a woman Sevak, the husband residing with her and dependent on her.
- Any other person related by blood or marriage to the Sevak or their spouse and wholly dependent on the Sevak.
- Specifically includes a widow and dependent Daughter-in-law.

Exclusions: Does not include a spouse legally separated from the Sevak, or a child/step-child no longer dependent or whose custody the Sevak has been deprived of by law.

Rule 3-A: Terms and Conditions of Engagement

- **Duty Hours:** A Sevak shall not be required to perform duty beyond a maximum period of **5 hours** in a day.
- **Age Limit:** A Sevak shall not be retained beyond **65 years** of age.
- **Livelihood Undertaking:** A Sevak must provide an undertaking that they have other sources of income besides the allowances paid by the Government to provide adequate means of livelihood for themselves and their family.
- **Transfer:** A Sevak can be transferred from one postal unit to another in public interest, vigilance, or administrative grounds.
- **Civil Service Status:** A Sevak shall be outside the Civil Service of the Union and shall not claim to be at par with Central Government employees.
- **Mandatory Residence:**
 - Residence in the post village/delivery jurisdiction of the Post Office within **one month** after selection but before engagement is mandatory.
 - Failure to reside in the place of duty for **GDS BPM** and within the delivery jurisdiction for other categories after engagement is a violation of conditions and liable for disciplinary action under **Rule 10**.
- **Accommodation:** The Post Office shall be located in accommodation provided by the **GDS BPM** suitable for use as Post Office premises.
 - However, if accommodation is provided by the Central/State Government, local Government, or Village Panchayat, that premise will be used.
- **Combination of Duties:** Combination of duties of a Sevak shall be permissible.

Rule 3-B: Eligibility Criteria for Engagement

Age

- **Minimum Age:** 18 years.
- **Maximum Age:** 40 years as on the date of notification of the vacancy.

Permissible Age Relaxations:

S.No.	Category	Permissible Age Relaxation
1	SC/ST	5 Years
2	OBC	3 Years
3	EWS	No relaxation
4	PwD/PH	10 Years
5	PwD/PH + SC/ST	15 Years
6	PwD/PH + OBC	13 Years

 **LEGISLATIVE NOTE:** While EWS candidates do not receive age relaxation, they are entitled to 10% reservation in engagement as per Directorate letter No. 17-09/2019 dated 26.02.2019.

Educational Qualification

- **Standard Qualification:** Secondary School Examination Pass certificate of **10th Standard** with passing marks in **Mathematics** and **English** as compulsory or elective subjects from a recognized board.
- **Compulsory Knowledge of Local Language:** The candidate must have studied the local language at least up to the **10th standard** (as compulsory or elective subjects).
- **Basic Computer Training:** Candidates must submit an undertaking declaring they have adequate knowledge to operate computer desktops, laptops, PoS, or mobile devices to work on Departmental software.

 **LEGISLATIVE NOTE:** The requirement for a formal basic computer training certificate was modified to a self-declaration/undertaking vide No. 17-02/2018-GDS dated 11.05.2022. (Current through 2025).

Disability Categories Suitable for Post

The following categories of disability are identified as suitable for GDS posts:

- (a) (LV) Low Vision.
- (b) D (Deaf), HH (Hard of Hearing).
- (c) OA (One Arm), OL (One Leg), Leprosy cured, Dwarfism, Acid Attack victim.
- (d) Specific Learning disability.
- (e) Multiple disabilities from the above categories, excluding Deaf and Blindness.

 **LEGISLATIVE NOTE:** Relaxation is not applicable for the "Blind" category; candidates with "Low Vision" are identified instead.

Rule 4: Engagement of Gramin Dak Sevaks

The engagement to various posts of Sevaks shall be made by the **Engaging Authority** as specified in the Schedule annexed to these rules. The engagement shall be made as per the instructions issued by the Department of Posts from time to time.

Rule 5: Time Related Continuity Allowance (TRCA)

The Gramin Dak Sevaks shall be entitled to such **Time Related Continuity Allowance (TRCA)** and other allowances as may be prescribed by the Government from time to time.

Current TRCA Structure (2025/2026):

Category	Minimum TRCA for 4 Hours/Level 1	Minimum TRCA for 5 Hours/Level 2
BPM	Rs. 12,000	Rs. 14,500
ABPM/ Dak Sevak	Rs. 10,000	Rs. 12,000

 **LEGISLATIVE NOTE:** The TRCA slabs were established following the implementation of the Kamlesh Chandra Committee recommendations. As of **2025**, GDS are also entitled to **Dearness Allowance (DA)** at the same rates as applicable to Central Government Employees, revised bi-annually.

Rule 6: Pension and Gratuity

The Gramin Dak Sevaks shall not be entitled to any pension. However, they shall be entitled to **Ex-gratia Gratuity** or any other benefit as may be decided by the Government from time to time.

 **LEGISLATIVE NOTE:** Currently, GDS are covered under the **Service Discharge Benefit Scheme (SDBS)** (a contribution-based scheme) and are eligible for **Ex-gratia Gratuity** up to a maximum of **Rs. 1,50,000** and **Severance Amount** up to **Rs. 1,50,000** based on length of service. (Updated 2025).

Rule 7: Leave

A Sevak shall be entitled to such leave as may be prescribed by the Government from time to time.

Summary of Leave Entitlements:

- **Paid Absence: 20 days** in a year (split into **10 days** per half-year). No carry-forward is allowed.
- **Emergency Leave: 5 days** in a calendar year.
- **Maternity Leave: 180 days** for female GDS.
- **Paternity Leave: 15 days** for male GDS.

 **LEGISLATIVE NOTE:** Provision for **Paternity Leave** and **Child Care Leave** for GDS was formally integrated following the OM dated **27.06.2018** and remains active in **2025**.

Rule 8: Termination of Engagement

(1) The engagement of a Sevak who has not completed **three years** of continuous engagement shall be liable to be terminated at any time by a notice in writing given either by the Sevak to the Engaging Authority or by the Engaging Authority to the Sevak.

(2) The period of such notice shall be **one month**:

Provided that the engagement of any such Sevak may be terminated forthwith by payment to the Sevak of a sum equivalent to the amount of their basic **Allowance** plus **Dearness Allowance** for the period of the notice at the same rates at which they were drawing them immediately before the termination of their engagement, or, as the case may be, for the period by which such notice falls short of **one month**.

Rule 9: Nature of Penalties

The following penalties may, for good and sufficient reasons and as hereinafter provided, be imposed on a Sevak by the **Disciplinary Authority**:

Minor Penalties:

1. **Censure.**
2. **Withholding of engagement** for a specific period.
3. **Recovery from TRCA** of the whole or part of any pecuniary loss caused to the Government by negligence or breach of orders.
4. **Withholding of annual increase** in TRCA without cumulative effect for a period not exceeding **three years**.
5. **Withholding of annual increase** in TRCA with cumulative effect for a specific period.

Major Penalties:

6. **Reduction to a lower stage** in the TRCA slab for a specified period exceeding **three years**.
7. **Compulsory Retirement.**
8. **Removal from Engagement** (Does not disqualify for future engagement).

9. **Dismissal from Engagement** (Ordinarily disqualifies for future engagement).

 **LEGISLATIVE NOTE:** Penalty No. 5 (Withholding increase with cumulative effect) was introduced to align GDS rules closer to CCS (CCA) Rules for better administrative control. (Updated 2025).

Rule 10-A: Procedure for Imposing Minor Penalty

No order imposing any of the penalties specified in **Clause (1) to (5)** of **Rule 9** shall be passed on a **GDS** except after:

- **(a)** The Sevak is informed in writing of the proposal to take action against him/her and of the allegation on which it is proposed to be taken and given an opportunity to make any representation he/she may wish to make; and
- **(b)** Such representation, if any, is taken into consideration by the **Engaging Authority**.

Rule 10-B: Procedure for Imposing Major Penalty

No order imposing any of the penalties specified in **Clause (6) to (9)** of **Rule 9** shall be passed on a **GDS** except after:

- **(a)** The Sevak is informed in writing of the proposal to take action against him/her and of the allegation on which it is proposed to be taken and given an opportunity to make any representation he/she may wish to make; and
- **(b)** Such representation, if any, is taken into consideration by the **Engaging Authority**.

Rule 10-C: Record of Proceedings

The record of Proceedings shall include:

1. A copy of the intimation to the Sevak of the proposal to take action against him/her.

2. A copy of the statement of allegations, along with a list of evidence in support thereof, communicated to him/her.
3. His/her representation, if any.
4. The records of the inquiry proceedings along with the inquiry report of the **Engaging Authority** or **Inquiry Officer**, if any, appointed in a case where a formal inquiry is necessary.
5. The representation, if any, of the Sevak on the **Inquiry Officer's** report.
6. Findings of the **Engaging Authority** in respect of the allegations.
7. The order imposing the penalty.

Rule 10-D: Inquiry Requirements

Inquiry has to be conducted even if the **GDS** accepts the charges in cases where a major penalty is to be imposed by the **Engaging Authority**.

- The purpose of holding an inquiry in such cases is primarily to give the **GDS** adequate opportunity to defend himself/herself.
- In case the charge is accepted by him/her unconditionally, there would obviously be no need for an inquiry for imposing a major penalty.

Rule 10-E: Discretionary Inquiry for Minor Penalties

Normally, there is no need for conduct of an inquiry for imposing a minor penalty on a **GDS**.

- However, where a minor penalty is to be imposed under **Rule 10**, it is up to the discretion of the **Disciplinary Authority** to decide whether an inquiry should be held or not in case of a request by the delinquent **GDS** received by the **Disciplinary/Engaging Authority**.

- The **Disciplinary/Engaging Authority** should apply its mind to all facts, circumstances, and reasons urged in the representation for holding a detailed inquiry and form an opinion whether an inquiry is necessary or not.
- If a delinquent **GDS** has asked for inspection of certain documents and cross-examination of prosecution witnesses, the Authority should apply its mind closely and not reject the request solely because an inquiry is not mandatory.
- If the Authority concludes an inquiry is not necessary, it should say so in writing, indicating its reasons, to avoid an action being construed as a denial of natural justice.

Rule 10-F: Procedure for Imposing Penalty After Discharge

Departmental proceedings under **Rule 10**, if instituted while a Sevak was in engagement, shall, after the discharge of the Sevak on attaining the age of **65 years**, be deemed to be proceedings under that rule and shall be continued and concluded by the authority by which the proceedings were commenced as if the Sevak had continued in engagement.

- The function of the **Disciplinary Authority** shall be only to reach a finding on the charges and submit a report recording its findings to the **President**.
- The final decision on such report shall be taken in the same manner as in the case of review petitions of the Sevaks addressed to the **President**, and no appeal shall lie against such decision.
- The **President** reserves the right of withholding group insurance amount, security amount, and post-engagement benefits like **Ex-gratia Gratuity/GDS Gratuity** and **Severance Amount** by ordering recovery if the Sevak is found guilty of grave misconduct or negligence.
- Departmental proceedings are deemed instituted on the date the statement of charge is issued or, if put off duty, on the date he/she was so put off.

Rule 10-G: Disciplinary Proceedings After Discharge (Fresh Cases)

1. (a) If proceedings were not instituted and the **GDS** is discharged at **65 years**, but benefits are withheld because proceedings were proposed, they shall be instituted after discharge and concluded by the proposed authority. Findings are submitted to the **President** for a final decision with no appeal permitted.

(b) Conditions for Fresh Proceedings:

- (i) Shall not be instituted save with the sanction of the **President**.
- (ii) Shall not be in respect of any event which took place more than **4 years** before such institution.
- (iii) Shall be conducted by such authority and place as the **President** may direct, following procedures applicable for dismissal.

(c) The **President** reserves the right to withhold security amounts and post-engagement benefits (GDS Gratuity/Severance) for grave misconduct or negligence.

2. Definitions for Institution of Proceedings:

- **Departmental:** Date statement of charges is issued or date placed under **Put Off Duty**.
- **Judicial (Criminal):** Date the complaint or police report is made of which the magistrate takes cognizance.
- **Judicial (Civil):** Date the plaint is presented in court.

Rule 11: Provisions Regarding Special Procedure

Notwithstanding anything contained in **Rule 10, 10-A, 10-B, and 10-C:**

- (i) Where any penalty is imposed on a Sevak on the ground of conduct which has led to his/her conviction on a criminal charge; or
- (ii) Where the **Engaging Authority** is satisfied for reasons to be recorded by it in writing that it is not reasonably practicable to hold an inquiry in the manner provided in these rules; or

- (iii) Where the **President** is satisfied that in the interest of the security of the State, it is not expedient to hold any inquiry in the manner provided in these rules;

The **Engaging Authority** may consider the circumstances of the case and make such orders thereon as it deems fit.

Rule 12: Put Off Duty

(1) The **Engaging Authority** or any authority to which it is subordinate or any other authority empowered by the **Government of India** in that behalf, may order a Sevak to be **Put Off Duty**:

- (a) Where a disciplinary proceeding against him/her is contemplated or is pending; or
- (b) Where a case against him/her in respect of any criminal offence is under investigation, inquiry, or trial.

(2) A Sevak shall be deemed to have been **Put Off Duty** by an order of **Engaging Authority**:

- (a) With effect from the date of his/her detention, if he/she is detained in custody, whether on a criminal charge or otherwise, for a period exceeding **forty-eight hours**;
- (b) With effect from the date of his/her conviction, if, in the event of a conviction for an offence, he/she is sentenced to a term of imprisonment exceeding **forty-eight hours** and is not forthwith dismissed or removed or compulsorily retired consequent to such conviction.

(3) A Sevak who is **Put Off Duty** shall be entitled to receive an amount of compensation (Ex-gratia payment) equal to **25%** of his/her **TRCA** together with admissible **Dearness Allowance**.

 **LEGISLATIVE NOTE:** The **Ex-gratia payment** of **25%** is fixed. However, if the period of 'Put Off Duty' exceeds **90 days**, the authority who made the order shall review the case. If the delay is not directly attributable to the GDS, the payment may be increased by up

to 50% of the initial ex-gratia (i.e., reaching 37.5% of TRCA). Conversely, if the delay is attributable to the GDS, it can be reduced. (Updated 2025).

(4) Where a Sevak is **Put Off Duty**, he/she shall not be entitled to any other allowances (e.g., Cycle Allowance, Combined Duty Allowance).

(5) An order of **Put Off Duty** made or deemed to have been made shall continue to remain in force until it is modified or revoked by the authority competent to do so.

Rule 13: Appeals

(1) A Sevak may appeal against an order of **Put Off Duty** or an order imposing upon him/her any of the penalties specified in **Rule 9** to the authority specified in the Schedule.

(2) **Limitation Period:** No appeal shall be entertained unless it is submitted within a period of **45 days** from the date on which the appellant receives a copy of the order appealed against.

 **LEGISLATIVE NOTE:** The Appellate Authority may entertain the appeal after the expiry of **45 days** if it is satisfied that the appellant had sufficient cause for not submitting the appeal in time.

Rule 14: Form and Content of Appeal

(1) Every person submitting an appeal shall do so separately and in his/her own name.

(2) The appeal shall be addressed to the authority to whom the appeal lies, a copy being forwarded by the appellant to the authority which made the order appealed against. It shall contain all material statements and arguments on which the appellant relies, shall not contain any disrespectful or improper language, and shall be complete in itself.

(3) The authority which made the order appealed against shall, on receipt of a copy of the appeal, forward the same with its comments thereon together with the relevant records to the **Appellate Authority** without any avoidable delay, and without waiting for any direction from the **Appellate Authority**.

Rule 15: Consideration of Appeal

(1) In the case of an appeal against an order of **Put Off Duty**, the **Appellate Authority** shall consider whether in the light of the provisions of **Rule 12** and having regard to the circumstances of the case, the order of **Put Off Duty** is justified or not and confirm or revoke the order accordingly.

(2) In the case of an appeal against an order imposing any of the penalties specified in **Rule 9**, the **Appellate Authority** shall consider:

- (a) Whether the procedure specified in these rules has been complied with;
- (b) Whether the findings of the **Disciplinary Authority** are warranted by the evidence on the record; and
- (c) Whether the penalty imposed is adequate, inadequate, or excessive;

And pass orders:

- (i) Confirming, enhancing, reducing, or setting aside the penalty; or
- (ii) Remitting the case to the authority which imposed the penalty or to any other authority with such direction as it may deem fit in the circumstances of the case.

Rule 16: Revision

(1) Notwithstanding anything contained in these rules:

- (i) The **President**; or
- (ii) Any authority subordinate to the **President** to which an appeal lies under these rules and within such amounts as may be prescribed by the Government in this behalf; or
- (iii) Any other authority specified in this behalf by the **President** by a general or special order;

May at any time, either on his or its own motion or otherwise, call for the records of any inquiry and revise any order made under these rules, and may:

- (a) Confirm, modify or set aside the order; or

- (b) Confirm, reduce, enhance or set aside the penalty imposed by the order, or impose any penalty where no penalty has been imposed; or
- (c) Remit the case to the authority which made the order or to any other authority directing such authority to make such further inquiry as it may consider proper in the circumstances of the case; or
- (d) Pass such other orders as it may deem fit.

(2) No proceeding for revision shall be commenced until after:

- (i) The expiry of the period of limitation for an appeal; or
- (ii) The disposal of the appeal, where any such appeal has been preferred.

(3) An application for revision shall be dealt with in the same manner as if it were an appeal under these rules, and the limitation for such application shall be **45 days** from the date on which the order was communicated to the Sevak.

Rule 17: Review

The **President** may, at any time, either on his own motion or otherwise, review any order passed under these rules, when any new material or evidence which could not be produced or was not available at the time of passing the order under review and which has the effect of changing the nature of the case, has come, or has been brought, to his notice:

Provided that no order imposing or enhancing a penalty shall be made by the **President** unless the Sevak concerned has been given a reasonable opportunity of making a representation against the penalty proposed.

Rule 18: Service of Notices and Orders

Every order, notice and other process made or issued under these rules shall be served in person on the Sevak concerned or communicated to him by registered post.

Rule 19: Power to Relax Time Limit and to Condone Delay

Save as otherwise expressly provided in these rules, the authority competent under these rules to make any order may, for good and sufficient reasons or if sufficient cause is shown, extend the time specified in these rules for anything required to be done under these rules or condone any delay.

Rule 20: General Conditions of Conduct

Every Sevak shall at all times:

- (i) Maintain absolute integrity;
- (ii) Maintain devotion to duty; and
- (iii) Do nothing which is unbecoming of a Sevak.

Rule 21: Prohibition of Striking Work

No Sevak shall engage himself/herself in any strike or in any similar activities. For the purposes of this rule, the expression "similar activities" includes:

- (i) Absence from duty without permission;
- (ii) Neglect of duty with the object of compelling any person to adopt a particular course of action;
- (iii) Any other type of demonstration, which is prejudicial to the interests of the Government.

Rule 22: Taking Part in Politics and Elections

(1) No Sevak shall be a member of, or be otherwise associated with, any political party or any organization which takes part in politics nor shall he/she take part in, subscribe in aid of, or assist in any other manner, any political movement or activity.

(2) It shall be the duty of every Sevak to endeavor to prevent any member of his/her family from taking part in, subscribing in aid of, or assisting in any other manner any movement or activity which is, or tends directly or indirectly to be, subversive of the Government as by law established.

(3) If a Sevak is unable to prevent a member of his/her family from taking part in, or subscribing in aid of, or assisting in any other manner, any such movement or activity, he/she shall make a report to that effect to the Government.

(4) No Sevak shall canvass or otherwise interfere with, or use his/her influence in connection with or take part in, an election to any legislature or local authority.

Rule 23: Joining of Associations by Sevaks

No Sevak shall join, or continue to be a member of, an association the objects or activities of which are prejudicial to the interests of the sovereignty and integrity of India, or public order or morality.

Rule 24: Demonstrations and Strikes

No Sevak shall:

- (i) Engage himself/herself or participate in any demonstration which is prejudicial to the interests of the sovereignty and integrity of India, the security of the State, friendly relations with foreign States, public order, decency or morality, or which involves contempt of court, defamation or incitement to an offence; or
- (ii) Resort to or in any way abet any form of strike or coercion or physical duress in connection with any matter pertaining to his/her conditions of engagement or the engagement of any other Sevak.

Rule 25: Connection with Press or Radio

(1) No Sevak shall, except with the previous sanction of the Government, own wholly or in part, or conduct or participate in the editing or management of, any newspaper or other periodical publication.

(2) No Sevak shall, except with the previous sanction of the Government or of the prescribed authority, or except in the bona fide discharge of his/her duties:

- (a) Publish a book himself/herself or through a publisher, or contribute an article to a book or a compilation of articles; or
- (b) Participate in a radio broadcast or contribute an article or write a letter to a newspaper or periodical either in his/her own name or anonymously or pseudonymously or in the name of any other person.

Provided that no such sanction shall be required:

- (i) If such publication is through a publisher and is of a purely literary, artistic or scientific character; or
- (ii) If such contribution, broadcast or writing is of a purely literary, artistic or scientific character.

Rule 26: Unauthorized Communication of Information

No Sevak shall, except in accordance with any general or special order of the Government or in the performance in good faith of the duties assigned to him/her, communicate, directly or indirectly, any official document or any part thereof or information to any Sevak or any other person to whom he/she is not authorized to communicate such document or information.

Rule 27: Insolvency and Habitual Indebtedness

A Sevak shall so manage his/her private affairs as to avoid habitual indebtedness or insolvency. A Sevak against whom any legal proceeding is instituted for the recovery of any debt due from him/her or for adjudging him/her as an insolvent shall forthwith report the full facts of the legal proceedings to the Government.

Rule 28: Vindication of Acts and Character of Sevak

(1) No Sevak shall, except with the previous sanction of the Government, have recourse to any Court or to the Press for the vindication of any official act which has been the subject matter of adverse criticism or an attack of a defamatory character.

(2) Nothing in this rule shall be deemed to prohibit a Sevak from vindicating his/her private character or any act done by him/her in his/her private capacity and where any action for vindicating his/her private character or any act done by him/her in private capacity is taken, the Sevak shall submit a report to the **Engaging Authority** regarding such action.

Rule 29: Canvassing of Non-Official or Other Outside Influence

No Sevak shall bring or attempt to bring any political or other outside influence to bear upon any superior authority to further his/her interests in respect of matters pertaining to his/her engagement under the Government.

Rule 29-A: Prohibition Regarding Engaging in any Business Detrimental to the Business of the Post Office/IPPB

No Sevak shall engage in any work or business which is detrimental to the business of the Post Office or **India Post Payments Bank (IPPB)**.

📝 **LEGISLATIVE NOTE:** This rule was specifically updated to include **IPPB** to ensure that GDS do not engage in private insurance, banking, or financial consultancy that competes with the Department's own financial services. (Updated 2025).

Rule 30: Interpretation

If any question arises relating to the interpretation of these rules, it shall be referred to the Government whose decision thereon shall be final.

Rule 31: Delegation of Powers

The Government may, by general or special order, direct that any power exercisable by it or any authority under these rules shall, subject to such conditions, if any, as may be specified in the order, be exercisable also by such officer or authority as may be specified in the order.

SCHEDULE: Competent Authorities for GDS

S No.	Post	Engaging Authority	Disciplinary Authority	Appellate Authority	Revision Authority	Review Authority
1.	BPM	Divisional Head (Gr. "A" JTS/STS/ Gr. "B")	Sub Divisional Head (For Minor Penalty 1-5) / Divisional Head (For Minor & Major 1-9)	DPS	PMG/CPMG	President
2.	ABPM/ Dak Sevak	Sub-Divisional Head (ASP/IP)	Sub-Divisional Head (For Minor & Major 1-9)	Divisional Head	DPS	President

 **LEGISLATIVE NOTE:** The **Review Authority** remains the **President of India** for all categories. Revisionary powers are typically vested in the **Director of Postal Services (DPS)** or **Postmaster General (PMG)** depending on the hierarchy of the initial Disciplinary Authority. (Current status 2025/2026).